MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CHICKEN STEW, COOKED, DEHYDRATED - (OPERATIONAL RATION COMPONENT)

This specification is approved for use by the Natick Research and Development Center, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers cooked, dehydrated chicken stew for use by the Department of Defense as a component of the Food Packet, Assault.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENT

2.1 Government documents. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-P-44146 - Packaging of Food Packet Assault Components in Flexible Bags

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8940

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STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

(Copies of documents required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

OTHER GOVERNMENT DOCUMENTS

Laws and Regulations

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

Poultry Products Inspection Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Carrots
U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Peas

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Chief, Processed Products Branch, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Office of Drinking Water, WH550, Environmental Protection Agency, Washington, DC 20460.)

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2.2 Other publications. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

THE UNITED STATES PHARMACOPOEIAL CONVENTION (USP)

Pharmacopoeia of the United States

(Application for copies should be addressed to the United States Pharmacopoeial Convention, Inc., 12601 Twinbrook Parkway, Rockville, MD 20852.)

AMERICAN DEHYDRATED ONION AND GARLIC ASSOCIATION (ADOGA)

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, 251 Kearney Street, No. 410, San Francisco, CA 94108.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.4, 6.1, and 6.2).

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3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent and insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Chicken breasts. The chicken breasts shall be chilled, uncooked, boneless and skinless breast halves prepared from broilers or fryers in accordance with the USDA Poultry Products Inspection Regulations. The chicken breasts shall meet the requirements for U.S. Grade A for fleshing. The chicken breasts shall not have been previously frozen and shall have been held at a temperature not to exceed 40°F for a period of time not to exceed 4 days following initial chilling and prior to preparation and further processing (see 3.3). The chicken shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA Grading Branch Certificate certifying initial chilling date. Mechanically deboned poultry meat shall not be used.

3.2.2 Carrots. Carrots shall be fresh or frozen and shall be mechanically diced with dicer settings at approximately 3/8 by 3/8 by 3/8 inch. The carrots shall be Danvers, Red-Cored Chatenay or similar varieties with comparable quality suitable for dehydration.

a. Carrots, fresh. The carrots shall be fresh, clean, sound, mature, and of good typical color. Fresh carrots shall be washed, peeled, sorted and trimmed in accordance with good commercial practice.

b. Carrots, frozen. The carrots shall be U.S. Grade A of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Carrots, and shall be of the most recent season's crop.

3.2.3 Chicken broth. Chicken broth may be purchased frozen or canned (thermostabilized). The broth shall be clear, essentially fat free with a 3.0 to 3.5 percent solids content. The broth shall have a characteristic mild-chicken-broth odor and flavor and may contain not more than 1.25 percent salt and/or flavor enhancers approved by the FDA. The chicken broth shall be produced in a USDA-inspected plant in accordance with USDA regulations and when frozen shall have been held at 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 75 days prior to use in the product.

3.2.4 Garlic powder. Garlic powder shall be fancy grade of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

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3.2.5 Octaglycerol monoleate. Octaglycerol monoleate, a polyglycerol ester of fatty acids, shall conform to the following requirements:

Saponification number	75 to 85
Hydroxyl number	495 to 550
Capillary melting point	Liquid at room temperature 1/
Acid value	5.0 maximum
Iodine value	30 to 40
Color/Form	Brown liquid at room temperature 1/
Hydrophile-lipophile balance (HLB)	13.0

1/ Viscosity at 50°C = 16000 cps.

3.2.6 Oil, vegetable. The vegetable oil shall be corn or cottonseed and shall have a stability of 15 hours (minimum), a free fatty acid content not to exceed 0.05 percent by weight, a moisture/volatile matter not to exceed 0.06 percent by weight and shall pass the cold test of 5.5 hours (minimum).

3.2.7 Onion, dehydrated, minced. The dehydrated minced onion shall be fancy grade of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

3.2.8 Peas, green, frozen. Frozen green peas shall comply with the requirements for U.S. Grade B or better of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Peas (prior to splitting or perforating) and shall be of the most recent season's crop. The peas shall be of a suitable freezer variety such as Thomas Laxton or Freezer Perfection. The peas shall be split or perforated to improve dehydration and rehydration characteristics.

3.2.9 Pepper, white, ground. Ground white pepper shall be derived from the dried mature berries of Piper nigrum L. from which the outer covering or the outer and inner coverings have been removed. The pepper shall have a characteristic, penetrating odor, a hot biting pungent flavor and a light color. The ground white pepper shall contain not less than 1.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground white pepper and be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 40 sieve.

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3.2.10 Potatoes. Potatoes shall be fresh and shall be a variety of excellent processing qualities and specific gravity of 0.95 to 1.10. Varieties with these characteristics include Russet, Burbank, Kennebec, Monona, and Norchips. The potatoes shall be washed, sorted, peeled, trimmed to remove defects and mechanically diced before cooking with dicer settings at approximately 3/8 by 3/8 by 3/8 inch. Dehydrated or dehydrofrozen potatoes shall not be used.

3.2.11 Poultry seasoning. The poultry seasoning shall be free from lumps, shall have an overall uniform color, and shall not tend to stratify in layers of individual spices. The poultry seasoning shall possess a fragrant, aromatic aroma and shall have a warm pungent taste. The poultry seasoning shall be prepared from ground spices having the characteristics listed below and shall be formulated as follows:

Ingredient	Percent by weight	Sieve size	Minimum volatile oil
Sage	72-78		1.0 mL per 100 g
Thyme	18-22		0.8 mL per 100 g
Pepper, black	4.5-5.5	95% through a U.S. No. 30 sieve	2.0 mL per 100 g

3.2.12 Salt. Salt shall be non-iodized, white, refined sodium chloride, with or without anti-caking agents.

3.2.13 Starch, freeze-thaw-stable. Freeze-thaw-stable starch shall form a smooth, short-textured, heavy bodied, almost clear aqueous solution. The flavor of the cooked solution shall be bland with essentially no cereal or starchy taste.

3.2.14 Turmeric, ground. Ground turmeric shall be prepared from Curcuma longa L. The ground turmeric shall possess a deep yellow to orange-yellow color with a peppery, aromatic odor. The ground turmeric shall contain not less than 3.5 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams and shall be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 40 sieve.

3.2.15 Water. Water used for formulation, ice making and washing shall conform to the National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

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3.2.16 Nitrogen. Nitrogen shall be U.S. Pharmacopoeia grade and shall be water or liquid nitrogen pumped.

3.3 Preparation and further processing.

3.3.1 Preparation of the chicken dices. The chicken dices shall be prepared as specified in 3.3.1.1 or 3.3.1.2. Mixing and stuffing shall be continuous and shall be completed within one day. After dicing, there shall be a minimum of 75 percent recognizable dices (approximately 3/8 by 3/8 by 1/4 inch).

3.3.1.1 Dicing before cooking. Chicken which is to be diced prior to cooking shall be prepared as follows:

a. Whole pieces of chicken breast meat shall be mechanically mixed until moderately tacky. No salt shall be used.

b. The chicken shall be mechanically tightly stuffed into suitable casings.

c. The uncooked chicken logs shall be frozen (see 3.3.1.3) or shall be chilled to a uniform temperature of 26° to 28°F prior to dicing. The chicken logs shall not be frozen more than one time.

d. The uncooked chilled chicken logs shall be mechanically diced with dicer settings at approximately 3/8 by 3/8 by 1/4 inch. Frozen uncooked chicken logs shall be tempered (see 6.3) to not higher than 28°F and mechanically diced as above.

e. The uncooked dices shall be cooked in steam to a minimum internal temperature of 160°F but not greater than 170°F.

f. If the cooked chicken dices are to be frozen (see 3.3.1.3) they shall be protected against freezer burn and deterioration. The cooked dices shall be placed in a freezer within 4 hours after completion of cooking.

3.3.1.2 Dicing after cooking. Chicken which is to be diced after cooking shall be prepared as follows:

a. Whole pieces of chicken breast meat shall be mechanically mixed with 1.0 percent salt until moderately tacky.

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b. The chicken shall be mechanically tightly stuffed into suitable casings.

c. The uncooked chicken logs shall be frozen (see 3.3.1.3) or shall be cooked in water or steam to a minimum internal temperature of 160°F but not greater than 170°F. The logs shall be cooked within 24 hours after stuffing.

d. The cooked chicken logs shall be frozen (see 3.3.1.3) or shall be chilled to a uniform temperature of 38°F or lower prior to dicing. The chicken logs shall not be frozen more than one time.

e. The chilled cooked chicken logs shall be mechanically diced with dicer settings at approximately 3/8 by 3/8 by 1/4 inch. Frozen cooked chicken logs shall be tempered (see 6.3) to not higher than 38°F and mechanically diced as above.

f. If the dices are produced from chilled logs, they may be frozen (see 3.3.1.3) and shall be protected against freezer burn and deterioration. If the dices are produced from stored, frozen, cooked logs, they shall not be frozen.

3.3.1.3 Time-temperature limitations. The chicken shall be handled so as to comply with the following limitations:

a. Maximum holding temperature and time of uncooked, chilled chicken breast:	40°F	4 days
b. Maximum holding temperature and time of uncooked chicken logs:		
1. If chicken logs are chilled	40°F	24 hours
2. If chicken logs are frozen 1/	0°F 2/	30 days
c. Maximum holding temperature and time of uncooked tempered chicken logs for dicing:	28°F	48 hours
d. Maximum holding temperature and time of uncooked chilled chicken dices:	40°F	24 hours
e. Maximum holding temperature and time of cooked, chilled chicken logs for dicing:	38°F 3/	48 hours

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f. Maximum holding temperature and time of cooked, frozen chicken logs for dicing:	0°F 4/	21 days
g. Maximum holding temperature and time of cooked, tempered chicken logs for dicing:	38°F	48 hours
h. Maximum holding temperature and time of cooked chicken dices:		
1. If cooked chicken dices are chilled	40°F	4 hours
2. If cooked chicken dices are frozen 5/	0°F 4/	14 days

1/ If chicken logs are frozen in the uncooked state they shall not be frozen after cooking and shall be used in the product within 24 hours after chilling.

2/ Uncooked chicken logs shall be frozen to 0°F within 72 hours after placing in the freezer.

3/ Cooked chicken logs shall be chilled to 38°F within 8 hours after cooking.

4/ Cooked chicken logs and cooked chicken dices shall be placed in a freezer within 4 hours after completion of cooking and frozen to an internal temperature of 0°F or below within 48 hours after placing in the freezer.

5/ Chicken dices prepared from chicken logs that have been frozen prior to cooking or cooked chicken logs that have been frozen prior to dicing shall not be frozen.

3.3.2 Preparation of the chicken stew. The chicken stew shall be prepared as preconcentrated and formed slices or as compressed bars. Slice preparation shall be as outlined by 3.3.2.1, 3.3.2.2 and 3.3.2.3. Bar preparation shall be as outlined by 3.3.2.1, 3.3.2.2 and 3.3.2.4.

3.3.2.1 Formulation of the chicken stew. The chicken stew shall be formulated as follows:

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Ingredient	Percent by weight	
	Formulation using chicken diced before cooking	Formulation using chicken diced after cooking
Chicken	30.0	30.0
Potatoes, raw, diced	20.0	20.0
Chicken broth	15.0	15.0
Water 1/	14.1	14.4
Peas, split or perforated	8.0	8.0
Carrots, diced	8.0	8.0
Oil, vegetable	2.0	2.0
Seasoning mix	1.9	1.6
Starch, freeze-thaw-stable	0.75	0.75
Octaglycerol monoleate	0.25	0.25
Seasoning mix		
Onion, dehydrated, minced	52.1	61.8
Salt	42.1	31.3
Poultry seasoning	2.7	3.2
Pepper, white, ground	1.5	1.8
Garlic powder	1.2	1.4
Turmeric, ground	0.4	0.5

1/ For preconcentrated and formed slices, the formula water shall be reduced by an amount that will yield a product complying with the finished product requirements.

3.3.2.2 Mixing and cooking. The chicken stew shall be mixed and cooked as follows:

a. The raw diced potatoes shall be cooked in boiling water until the potatoes have firm edges and a slightly raw flavor. The potato dices shall be rinsed with cold water to stop cooking and remove starch.

b. Fresh carrots shall be blanched before use in the product.

c. A slurry shall be made with the starch and the chicken broth.

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d. The seasoning mix and water shall be added to the slurry, mixed well and heated to a temperature of 180°F.

e. The vegetable oil and octaglycerol monoleate shall be mixed well into the above mixture.

f. The peas, carrots and chicken dices shall be added to the mixture, mixed gently without breaking the chicken dices, and heated to a temperature of 140°F.

g. The precooked potatoes shall be added and mixed in gently.

3.3.2.3 Slice preparation. The preconcentrated and formed slices shall be prepared as follows; or alternatively, the cooked product may be formed so that the dimensions, weights and volumes specified in 3.4 (e) are met. The times and temperatures specified below shall be followed according to the process being used.

a. The cooked product shall be immediately mechanically stuffed into suitable casings. Casings shall have an approximate 5-1/2 inch lay-flat dimension.

b. Each stuffed casing shall be formed (see 6.4) into a rectangular shape in accordance with 3.4(e).

c. The product shall be placed in a freezer within 4 hours after stuffing and frozen to an internal temperature of 0°F or below within 24 hours after placing in the freezer. Frozen product shall not be held for longer than 30 days before slicing and freeze dehydration.

d. The frozen product shall be cut into slices so that four dehydrated slices will meet the requirements specified in 3.4(e).

e. The slices shall be placed in the freezer dryer and dehydrated as specified in 3.3.3. The dehydration shall be started within 24 hours after slicing. The product shall be protected at all times from contamination and freezer burn.

3.3.2.4 Bar preparation. The compressed bars shall be prepared as follows:

a. The cooked product shall be portioned onto freeze dryer trays.

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b. The product shall be placed in a freezer within 4 hours after cooking and frozen to 0°F or lower within 12 hours after placing in the freezer. The product shall be protected at all times from contamination and freezer burn.

c. The product shall be placed in the freeze dryer and dehydrated as specified in 3.3.3. The dehydration shall be started within 48 hours after placing in the freezer.

d. The dehydrated product shall be conditioned by adding 12 percent by weight of water. The moistened product shall be processed in a microwave unit at the equivalent of 30 seconds at 1000 watts (see 6.5).

e. The conditioned product shall be compressed into bars 1 inch wide by 3 inches long by not more than 1-1/4 inches thick so that three dehydrated bars will meet the requirements specified in 3.4(f). The compressed bars shall have edges and corners rounded to a nominal 1/8 inch curvature. The product shall be compressed within 5 days of initial freeze dehydration.

f. The compressed bars shall be placed in the freeze dryer and dehydrated as specified in 3.3.3. The dehydration shall be started within 48 hours of compression.

3.3.3 Dehydration. The chicken stew shall be freeze dehydrated at an absolute pressure not to exceed 1.5 millimeters of mercury and at a product temperature as indicated by suitable instruments, not to exceed 150°F. If the platen temperature is maintained at 155°F or below with radiant heating, the product temperature may be disregarded. After dehydration is completed, the pressure shall be equalized to atmospheric level with nitrogen. In no case shall more than 16 hours elapse between dehydration and completion of packaging. During this interim period, product shall be adequately protected from oxygen and moisture by either holding under a nitrogen atmosphere with 2.0 percent or less oxygen, or under a vacuum of at least 27 inches of mercury for the entire period. If vacuum is used, it shall be broken with nitrogen. For compressed bar product during the interim between freeze drying and compression the product shall also be protected as above.

3.3.4 Pouch filling and sealing. Each pouch shall be filled and sealed such as to conform to the following requirements:

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a. Three bars or four slices shall be inserted into a mixing bag conforming to the requirements of MIL-P-44146.

b. The bag closure device (see MIL-P-44146) shall be placed within the outer folds of the mixing bag so as to minimize any sharp protrusions against the pouch.

c. The filled mixing bag shall be folded and fitted into a pouch.

d. The pouch shall be sealed in accordance with the requirements of MIL-P-44146.

3.4 Finished product. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

Dehydrated product

:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as but not limited to dirt, glass, or paint, hard plastic, wood, insects, insect parts or noxious chemicals. There shall be no innocuous soft extraneous material (paper, string, etc.), smears or stains (oil, grease, etc.).

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, musty, or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. There shall be no evidence of incomplete dehydration.

e. When the product is in the form of slices:

1. Each pouch shall contain four slices.
2. Each slice shall be approximately 2.25± 0.1 by 3.25± 0.1 by 1/2 to 3/4 inches.
3. The volume of the four slices shall be not greater than 246 cubic centimeters.
4. The total weight of the four slices shall be not less than 90 grams and not greater than 100 grams.

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f. When the product is in the form of bars:

1. Each pouch shall contain three bars.
2. Each bar shall be 3 ± 0.1 by 1 ± 0.1 by not greater than 1-1/4 inches.
3. The total weight of the three bars shall be not less than 90 grams and not greater than 100 grams.
4. Each bar shall have rounded edges and corners.

g. The product shall be sufficiently compressed or formed so that it can be packaged without breaking or crumbling.

h. Moisture content of the dehydrated product shall not exceed 2.0 percent.

i. The aerobic plate count shall be not greater than 75,000 per gram in four of five samples and not greater than 150,000 per gram in any sample.

j. The E. coli count shall be less than 3 per gram (no positives in the standard 3 tube MPN technique) in four of five samples and not greater than 20 per gram in any sample.

Rehydrated product:

k. When the product is rehydrated as specified in footnote 3 of table I the product shall show not less than 85 percent rehydration.

l. The rehydrated chicken stew shall possess flavor, odor and texture considered normal for frozen and heated chicken stew. There shall be no scorched, burnt, or foreign flavors or odors.

m. When rehydrated the chicken stew shall show distinct pieces of chicken meat (approximately 3/8 by 3/8 by 1/4 inch), potatoes, and carrots and whole peas. The product shall not be a mass of indistinguishable materials.

3.4.1 Palatability. The product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

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3.5 Plant qualification. The poultry component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under Poultry Products Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

3.6 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this document. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and acceptance service. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of acceptance service necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this document. The cost of grading and acceptance services performed by the USDA involving inspection, official documentation, and related services shall be borne by the contractor.

4.3 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this document and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this document or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

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4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition and other requirements shall be determined by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade certificates, invoices, certificates of analysis, or other valid documents. In addition, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically as necessary to determine conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to preparation, processing, handling and filling requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of time, temperature, and formulation or other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.3 Filled and sealed pouch examination. Inspection of filled and sealed pouches shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-P-44146.

4.5.4 Net weight inspection. The net weight of the filled and sealed pouches shall be determined by weighing each sample unit on a suitable scale tared with a representative empty pouch, mixing bag and closure device. Any individual net weight of less than 90 grams or greater than 100 grams shall be scored as a major defect. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed pouch. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5. Results shall be reported to the nearest 1 gram.

4.5.5 Volume test (slices only). Test for volume of slices shall be performed as follows:

Equipment

a. Container, large enough to submerge pouches in; having a spout approximately 1 inch below the container surface.

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b. 150 gm weight with a clip attached.

c. 250 mL or 500 mL beaker.

d. 250 mL or 500 mL graduated cylinder.

e. Vacuum-sealed pouch containing a mixing bag and a closure device.

Procedure

a. Establish tare as follows:

(1) Place container on a level, vibration-free surface.

(2) Fill the container with water until the water comes out the spout. Wait until the water stops dripping before proceeding.

(3) Position the beaker under the spout.

(4) Attach the vacuum-sealed pouch containing a mixing bag and a closure device to the 150 gm weight with the clip. Submerge the pouch with the attached weight into the filled container.

(5) Allow the water to stop dripping before measuring, approximately 5 minutes.

(6) Measure the collected water in the graduated cylinder and record this measurement as the volume of the tared pouch. Report measurement to the nearest 2 mL.

(7) Empty and dry the beaker and graduated cylinder.

b. Testing of filled and sealed pouch:

(1) Refill the container and, using the same procedure as above, test the filled and sealed pouch.

(2) Measure the collected water in the graduated cylinder and record this measurement as the volume of the filled and sealed pouch. Report measurement to the nearest 2 mL.

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c. Determine the volume of the slices using the following equation:

Volume of filled and sealed pouch	minus	Volume of the tared pouch	=	Volume of the slices.

The lot size shall be expressed in filled and sealed pouches. Any result not conforming to the requirement in 3.4e shall be scored as a major defect. The sample size shall be the number of pouches indicated by inspection level S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

4.5.6 Product examination. The finished product shall be examined for the defects listed in table I. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be the contents of one filled and sealed pouch. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5 for major defects and 6.5 for minor defects.

TABLE I. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
151		Mixing bag missing.
152		Number of bars/slices in pouch not as specified.
	201	Bag closure device missing.
		Applicable to dehydrated product
153		Evidence of incomplete dehydration.
	202	Broken or crumbled (more than 3 large pieces) bar/slice.
	203	Dimensions of compressed bars not as specified.
	204	Edges and corners of compressed bars not rounded.
		Applicable to rehydrated product 3/
154		Product shows less than 85 percent rehydration. 4/

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TABLE I. Product defects 1/ 2/ (cont'd)

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
155		Product does not show distinct pieces of chicken meat (approximately 3/8 by 3/8 by 1/4 inch),potatoes, and carrots and whole peas (i.e., the product is a mass of indistinguishable materials).

1/ The presence of any foreign material (e.g. glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal, etc.), foreign odor or flavor (e.g. burnt, scorched, moldy, noxious chemicals, rancid, sour, stale, etc.) foreign color, or innocuous soft extraneous material, smears or stains (oil, grease, etc.) shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability or overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an AMS agent.)

3/ To perform rehydration examination, the entire contents of the pouch shall be used. Break bars or slices each into five or six pieces of comparable size. Add 180° to 200°F water to the broken product in the amount of 3.5 mL of water for each gram of dehydrated product and weigh. Stir to expose all surfaces to the water. Rehydrate for 5 minutes, stir, and rehydrate for an additional 5 minutes. Immediately after the 10 minute rehydration period, pour contents onto a U.S. Standard No. 40 sieve. Drain for 5 minutes and weigh.

4/ Percent rehydration shall be calculated as follows:

$$\frac{\text{Weight of rehydrated product}}{\text{Weight of dry product plus added water}} \times 100 = \text{Percent rehydration}$$

4.5.7 Moisture content testing. The finished product shall be tested for moisture content in accordance with the Moisture-Drying in Vacuum Method in the Meat Section of the Meat and Meat Products Chapter in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, except

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that a temperature of 70°C for 16 hours under a pressure of 100 mm of mercury shall be used. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result not conforming to the requirement in 3.4h shall be considered as a major defect. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed pouch. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5.

4.5.8 Microbiological testing. Five filled and sealed pouches of finished product shall be selected at random from the lot regardless of lot size. The contents of each sample pouch shall be tested for aerobic plate count and E. coli in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Microbiological Methods: Section: Examination of Frozen, Chilled, Precooked, or Prepared Foods - Official First Action. The diluent shall be added to each sample of dry product and allowed to stand for 15 minutes before the blending of that sample. Continue as directed by AOAC. Any result not conforming to the requirements of 3.4 i and j shall be considered a test failure. Any test failure shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.9 Packaging inspection. Inspection of packaging shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-P-44146.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be in accordance with the applicable requirements of MIL-P-44146.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4 and 6.2).
c. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.4.1 and 6.2).

6.2 First article . When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.3 Tempering. Tempering shall not be considered freezing and is defined as product chilled below 20°F and tempered up to dicing temperature.

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6.4 Forming of slices. Good results have been achieved for forming the preconcentrated slices by placing the casings into screen molds prior to stuffing. Acceptable molds have been found to be those produced by Beacon Metal Products, Inc. of Chicago, Illinois.

6.5 Compression, general. The best results for microwave heating have been achieved by placing the food in a closed container, e.g., a plastic bag, and placing the bagged food flat in the bottom of the oven. If the heating is done in 10 to 15 second cycles, turning the container, and mixing the food between cycles, more thorough distribution of the moisture will be achieved. Products with high fat content may require 1 to 2 minutes to cool before compression.

Custodian:

Army - GL

Review activities:

Army - MD, TS
DP - SS

Preparing activity:

Army -GL

Project No. 8940-A472

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-C-44148(GL)	Chicken Stew, Cooked, Dehydrated - (Operational Ration Component)

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NATICK OP, 1 Apr 84

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